

GUILDS: COIN, VOICE & DISCIPLINE

GUILDS: COIN, VOICE & DISCIPLINE IS A settlement-scale NPC supplement for 5e that explores the organized professions governing trade, culture, and personal discipline within a functioning city. Rather than portraying these classes as wandering adventurers, this book presents them as structured institutions that train apprentices, regulate professions, and maintain social influence.

Each ladder represents a professional hierarchy rather than a band of heroes. Apprentices, inspectors, envoys, instructors, and senior authorities enforce standards within their respective guilds. These characters are not designed to seek treasure or explore distant ruins. They exist to maintain order within commerce, public expression, and disciplined personal mastery.

The intent of this product is to provide grounded NPC roles suitable for urban campaigns, political intrigue, and institutional encounters. The creatures in this supplement are intentionally restrained in power compared to typical adventuring parties. They represent professional authority, skilled specialists, and respected masters rather than legendary adventurers.

Cultural detail is intentionally minimal. Whether these guilds cooperate, compete for influence, or quietly manipulate civic leadership is left to the GM. Merchant authorities may clash with religious doctrine, traveling performers may influence politics through public sentiment, and monastic orders may pursue discipline that few outsiders truly understand. These stat blocks provide the framework. How these institutions shape the city is your story to tell.

THE TRADES GUILD

The Trades Guild regulates skilled labor and craftsmanship within the city. Apprentices learn under licensed masters, guild inspectors enforce standards of quality, and senior artisans control access to trade knowledge and economic influence.

Trades encounters emphasize professional skill, organized labor, and civic authority through economic power. Craftsmen may not wield great magic or divine influence, but the city depends on their work, and the guild protects its interests carefully.

THE COLLEGE OF VOICE

The College of Voice represents the organized tradition of performers, musicians, and cultural envoys. Bards influence public sentiment through music, storytelling, and diplomacy, shaping how people think and how leaders are remembered.

Voice encounters emphasize charisma, performance, and social influence. Members of the college rarely dominate through violence; instead they inspire crowds, negotiate conflicts, and quietly influence the politics of a city through reputation and persuasion.

THE MONASTIC ORDER

The Monastic Order governs disciplined training in body and mind. Monasteries produce warriors of focus and restraint who value mastery over spectacle. Students learn patience, control, and precision through years of dedicated practice.

Monastic encounters emphasize martial discipline, controlled movement, and personal mastery. These monks rarely seek glory. Instead they train, teach, guard sacred spaces, and intervene only when necessary to restore balance or protect their traditions.

TRADES GUILD ROSTER

Name	Challenge Rating	Description
Tradesman Apprentice	0	Young worker beginning formal training under guild supervision.
Licensed Tradesman	1	Recognized professional authorized to practice a skilled trade within the city.
Guild Foreman	2	Experienced crafts leader responsible for supervising large projects and labor crews.
Guild Inspector	3	Authority tasked with enforcing trade standards and investigating violations.
Master Guildsman	5	Senior artisan controlling guild knowledge, training, and economic influence.

COLLEGE OF VOICE ROSTER

Name	Challenge Rating	Description
College Busker	0	Street performer learning the fundamentals of public entertainment.
Licensed Bard	1	Recognized performer authorized to represent the college in public venues.
Court Performer	2	Refined musician and storyteller serving noble courts and elite audiences.
College Envoy	3	Diplomatic bard representing the college in political or cultural negotiations.
Grand Virtuoso	5	Legendary performer whose reputation carries influence across entire regions.

MONASTIC ORDER ROSTER

Name	Challenge Rating	Description
Monastery Novice	0	Young student beginning the long discipline of monastic training.
Ordained Monk	1	Fully trained martial practitioner practicing the monastery's traditions.
Temple Guardian	2	Disciplined defender responsible for protecting sacred grounds.
Order Instructor	3	Senior teacher guiding the next generation of disciplined monks.
Grand Master	5	Supreme authority of the monastery, representing perfected discipline and mastery.

GUILD INSPECTOR

Medium humanoid (any), any alignment

Armor Class 11

Hit Points 52 (8d8 + 16)

Speed 30 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
12 (+1)	12 (+1)	14 (+2)	13 (+1)	13 (+1)	13 (+1)

Skills Insight +3, Investigation +5, Perception +3, Persuasion +3

Tools One set of artisan's tools

Senses passive Perception 13

Languages Common plus one other

Challenge 3 (700 XP)

Guild Authority. This humanoid has advantage on Charisma (Persuasion) checks made to enforce guild law, shut down illegal workshops, or confiscate goods that violate guild contracts.

Trade Tools. This humanoid carries artisan's tools appropriate to its trade. When making ability checks related to its craft, it adds double its proficiency bonus.

Investigative Training. This humanoid has advantage on Intelligence (Investigation) checks made to detect counterfeit goods, contract violations, or illegal trade.

ACTIONS

Multiattack. This humanoid makes two Tool Strike attacks.

Tool Strike. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +3 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* 6 (1d10 + 1) bludgeoning damage.

- This guild member is encountered inspecting markets, workshops, and construction projects.
- It attempts to resolve disputes through authority and investigation before fighting.
- If threatened, it calls guards or guild members rather than engaging alone.



COLLEGE ENVOY

Medium humanoid (any), any alignment

Armor Class 12

Hit Points 52 (8d8 + 16)

Speed 30 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
10 (+0)	14 (+2)	14 (+2)	13 (+1)	13 (+1)	16 (+3)

Skills Insight +3, Investigation +3, Performance +5, Persuasion +5

Senses passive Perception 11

Languages Common plus two others

Challenge 3 (700 XP)

Diplomatic Authority. This humanoid has advantage on Charisma (Persuasion) checks made to mediate disputes, negotiate agreements, or represent the Bardic College in official matters.

Silver Tongue. As long as this humanoid can speak and be heard, allied creatures within 30 feet have advantage on their first Charisma check each round.

ACTIONS

Multiattack. This humanoid makes two Dagger attacks.

Dagger. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +4 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target.
Hit: 5 (1d4 + 3) piercing damage.

Cutting Remark. *Ranged Spell Attack:* +5 to hit, range 60 ft., one creature. *Hit:* 9 (2d6 + 2) psychic damage.

- This bard represents the College in negotiations, courts, and civic disputes.
- It attempts to resolve conflicts with persuasion before violence.
- In combat it stays behind allies while undermining enemies with sharp words and careful positioning.



GRAND MASTER

Medium humanoid (any), any alignment

Armor Class 17 (unarmored defense)

Hit Points 95 (14d8 + 28)

Speed 45 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
14 (+2)	18 (+4)	14 (+2)	12 (+1)	16 (+3)	12 (+1)

Skills Acrobatics +7, Insight +6, Perception +6

Senses passive Perception 16

Languages Common plus two others

Challenge 5 (1,800 XP)

Perfect Discipline. Allied monks within 30 feet who can see this humanoid gain advantage on their first attack roll each round and have advantage on saving throws against being frightened.

Unarmored Defense. While wearing no armor and wielding no shield, this humanoid adds its Wisdom modifier to its Armor Class.

Evasion. If this humanoid is subjected to an effect that allows it to make a Dexterity saving throw to take only half damage, it instead takes no damage if it succeeds on the saving throw, and only half damage if it fails.

ACTIONS

Multiattack. This humanoid makes three Unarmed Strike attacks.

Unarmed Strike. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +7 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* 8 (1d8 + 4) bludgeoning damage.

REACTIONS

Deflect Strike. When this humanoid is hit by a melee weapon attack, it reduces the damage by 10 (1d10 + 5).

- This monk represents the highest discipline of the order and rarely enters combat unless necessary.
- It prefers calm control of the battlefield, positioning itself where it can guide and support other monks.
- If forced into battle, it uses speed, precision, and defense to outlast opponents rather than overpower them.



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